WEEK 12 / COMMUNITIES, CREATIVITY, AND PLAYER CULTURE

Gaming Communities and Tabletop Role-Playing Games

How gaming brings us together / divides us.

This week, we explore how gaming brings people together and how it can also create divisions within communities. We will discuss the social dynamics of gaming, including both positive and negative aspects. We'll also take a look at tabletop role-playing games (TTRPGs) and their impact on gaming culture, examining how these games foster creativity, collaboration, and storytelling within communities.

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30 RESOURCES / 1 TOPIC

TOPIC 01

Gaming and Community

REQUIRED

The Evolution Of The LAN Party

YOUTUBE | ~23 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dm7f47bTu9M&ab_channel=Nicktorious

LO 1: Students will be able to explain the historical development of video games, from early arcade games to contemporary digital gaming platforms.
LO 5: Students will gain insights into how technologies like artificial intelligence, virtual reality, and online connectivity shape gaming experiences.
LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

The Impact Of Gaming: A Benefit To Society

ARTICLE | ~3 MIN

https://www.forbes.com/sites/kevinanderton/2018/06/25/the-impact-of-gaming-a-benefit-to-society-infographic/

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.
LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

The Impact of Video Games on Culture (from Understanding Media and Culture: An Introduction to Mass Communication)

BOOK EXCERPT | ~17 MIN

https://saylordotorg.github.io/text_understanding-media-and-culture-an-introduction-to-mass-communication/s13-03-the-impact-of-video-games-on-c.html

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REQUIRED

What is Toxicity in Games?

BLOG POST | ~7 MIN

https://indiecator.org/2023/09/27/what-is-toxicity-in-games/

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.
LO 3: Students will explore the applications of video games beyond entertainment, including their use in medicine, education, and social engagement.
LO 4: Students will be able to discuss ethical concerns surrounding gaming, including issues related to violence, addiction, monetization practices, labor concerns, and virtual identities.

REQUIRED

Pros and Cons of Gamer Communities

ARTICLE | ~3 MIN

https://www.rubiconline.com/pros-and-cons-of-gamer-communities/

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REQUIRED

Video Games Are Social Spaces: How Video Games Help People Connect

ARTICLE | ~5 MIN

https://www.jcfs.org/response/blog/video-games-are-social-spaces-how-video-games-help-people-connect

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LO 4: Students will be able to discuss ethical concerns surrounding gaming, including issues related to violence, addiction, monetization practices, labor concerns, and virtual identities.
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REQUIRED

Gaming for Healthy Social Interaction and Community Building with Brennan | Qwe're Coping Together

YOUTUBE | ~19 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=v7jbIh8APAM

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LO 4: Students will be able to discuss ethical concerns surrounding gaming, including issues related to violence, addiction, monetization practices, labor concerns, and virtual identities.
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REQUIRED

How Video Games Have Changed The World

ARTICLE | ~5 MIN

https://www.masterycoding.com/blog/how-video-games-have-changed-the-world

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LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

REQUIRED

Gaming culture around the world: different strokes for different regions

ARTICLE | ~5 MIN

https://thedailyaztec.com/116181/sponsored/gaming-culture-around-the-world-different-strokes-for-different-regions/

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REQUIRED

Video Games from Different Cultures

ARTICLE | ~10 MIN

https://maceandcrown.com/2162/technology/from-the-international-video-games-from-different-cultures/

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LO 6: Students will understand the variety of gaming experiences, from indie games to eSports, and will recognize the contributions of diverse communities within the gaming industry.

EXPLORE FURTHER

Dangerous games : what the moral panic over role-playing games says about play, religion, and imagined worlds by Joseph Laycock

BOOK

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1i25tbk/alma991048182448308681

EXPLORE FURTHER

Coin-Operated Americans: Rebooting Boyhood at the Video Game Arcade by Carly A Kocurek

BOOK

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1oa9cn5/cdi_proquest_ebookcentral_EBC4391801

EXPLORE FURTHER

Ultima and Worldbuilding in the Computer Role-Playing Game by Carly Kocurek and Matthew Thomas Payne

BOOK

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1oa9cn5/cdi_oapen_primary_oai_library_oapen_org_20_500_12657_88623

EXPLORE FURTHER

Retro 90s LAN Party - Spring 2025

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=m8-jKZSoCGo

EXPLORE FURTHER

What online game has the NICEST community?

REDDIT

https://www.reddit.com/r/gamingsuggestions/comments/18lcvef/what_online_game_has_the_nicest_community/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Call of Duty Anti-Toxicity / Disruptive Behavior Progress Report

BLOG POST

https://www.callofduty.com/blog/2024/10/call-of-duty-anti-toxicity-progress-report-black-ops-6-moderation-results

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Untapped Potential of the Gaming Community: Narrative Review

ARTICLE

https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6231821/

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Psychology of Play: How Gaming Communities Impact Mental Well-Being

ARTICLE

https://guildservices.org/blog/the-psychology-of-play-how-gaming-communities-impact-mental-well-being/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Developing a Measure of Community Health in Games

ARTICLE

https://rachelkowert.substack.com/p/developing-a-measure-of-community

EXPLORE FURTHER

Video Gaming 101: Healthy vs Problematic Gaming

ARTICLE

https://www.childrenandscreens.org/learn-explore/research/video-gaming-101-healthy-vs-problematic-gaming/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Online Gaming Communities Could Provide A Lifeline For Isolated Young Men

ARTICLE

https://stories.tamu.edu/news/2023/08/23/online-gaming-communities-could-provide-a-lifeline-for-isolated-young-men/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Why Video Game Community Managers Suck at Their Jobs

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TvDOD6NW8K8

EXPLORE FURTHER

YouTube clip from Mythic Quest about community managers

JUST FOR FUN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gCM30xHTegc

EXPLORE FURTHER

Gaming in Color

DOCUMENTARY | DIVERSITY IN VIDEO GAMES IS EXTRAORDINARILY IMPORTANT - ESPECIALLY TO THE PEOPLE WHO PLAY THEM. EXPLORE THE STORY OF THE QUEER GAMING COMMUNITY, 'GAYMER' CULTURE AND EVENTS, AND THE RISE OF LGBTQ THEMES IN VIDEO GAMES.

https://athome.fandango.com/content/browse/details/Gaming-in-Color/657736

EXPLORE FURTHER

How Different Countries Change Videogames

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vVIROLHauNk&ab_channel=St1ka

EXPLORE FURTHER

I Visited Every U.S State (in video games) - this bookmark is for Maine

YOUTUBE

https://youtu.be/O5b0KIjRiF4?si=_GmD5LQk6UvtUHuG&t=6663

I Visited Every U.S State (in video games) - this bookmark is for Maine (the Silent Hill games are set in Maine and there is a Fallout 4 DLC set in Maine as well)

EXPLORE FURTHER

Let’s “game” it!: Dangerous games, a new health challenge

ARTICLE

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1oa9cn5/cdi_proquest_miscellaneous_3151584943

Let’s “game” it!: Dangerous games, a new health challenge (not directly about video games, but about peer pressure)

EXPLORE FURTHER

ROMchip Presents: Carly A. Kocurek on Dolly Ludens: American Girl Dolls Playing Games

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MD6pb-DcsMY

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Troll Project

WEBSITE

https://thetrollproject.com/

EXPLORE FURTHER

Healthy Gamer

WEBSITE

https://www.healthygamer.gg/